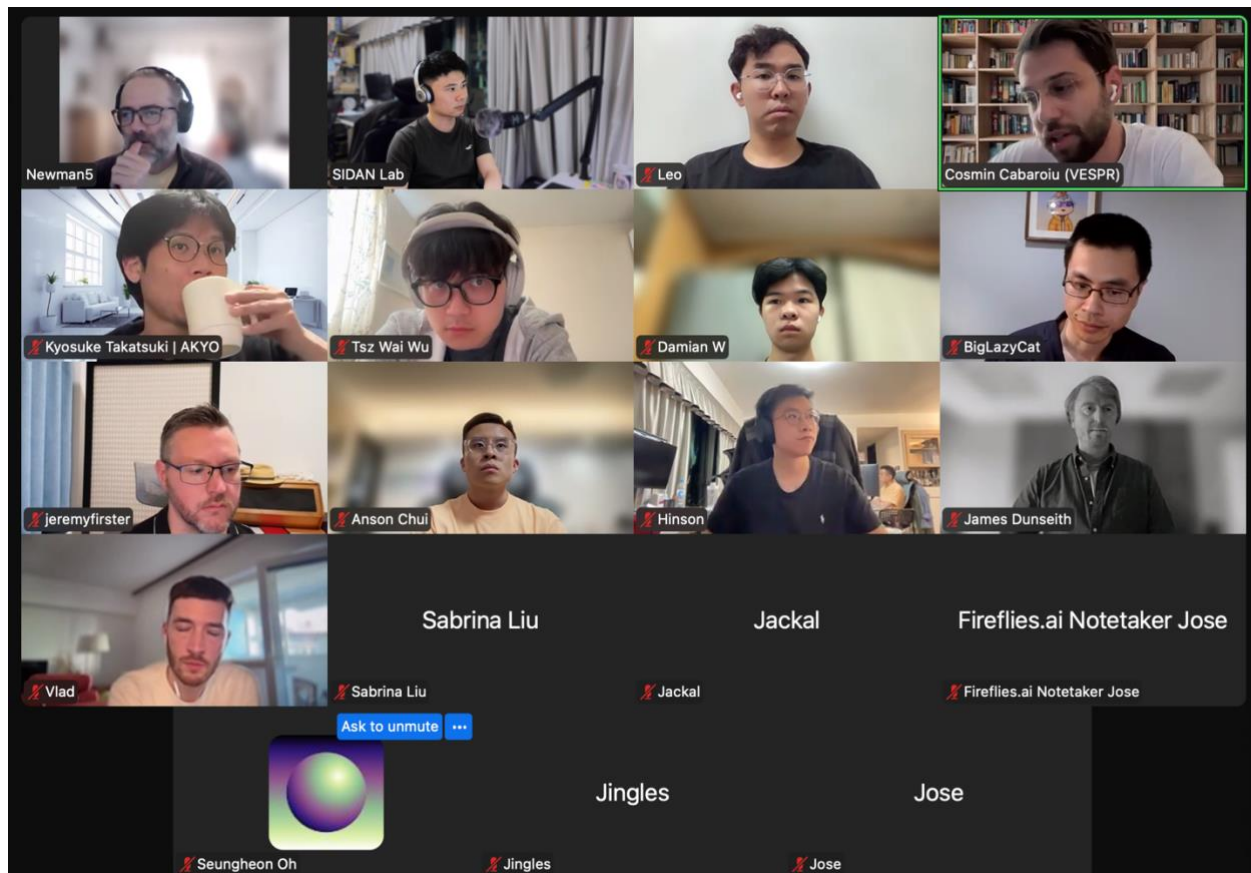


Gimbalabs | VESPR - Cardano Onboarding Workshop

Guideline: Regional Discussions with Builders Meeting Notes



Attendees

The meeting brought together community members from across the global Cardano ecosystem:

- United States: Newman (Gimbalabs) and Jame, Seungheon(IO)
- Singapore: Jingles, TW (Mesh)
- Argentina: Jose, Rodrigo (Cardano Ambassador)
- Portugal: Lucas (45B)
- Taiwan: Sabrina, Leo, and Jeremy
- Canada: Damian and Eric (BigLazyCat)
- Japan: Akyo(SPO)
- Hong Kong: Hinson, Anson, Neal (DeltaDeFi/SIDAN)
- Romania: Vlad and Cosmin (Vesper)

The meeting was hosted by Neal with the objective of gathering different perspectives from around the globe on "how to onboard new users" to create a universally applicable onboarding Playbook. Newman from Gimbalabs in the US emphasized a crucial concept at the beginning: we must differentiate between an "end-user" and a "builder/prosumer." End-users are simply consumers of Web3 applications or financial products and do not need complex development skills.

Key message

Participant Name	Region	Core Perspective	Onboarding Strategy	Target Audience	Key Concerns/Barriers
Newman	United States	Differentiate between end-users and builder-prosumers to focus on relevant skills for each group.	Focus on the conceptual landscape, user needs, and ecosystem tools like wallets and explorers.	End-users, builders, and prosumers.	Urgent crisis of lacking value propositions; community dysfunction.
Hinsson	Hong Kong	Leverage community building as a funnel for talent recruitment and institutional partnership.	Organizing developer series, physical workshops, and side events to bridge traditional finance with Cardano tech.	Developers, interns, and financial institutions.	General public is blockchain agnostic; need to provide practical product feedback for DeFi development.
Neal	Hong Kong	Standardizing regional insights into a universal playbook while targeting younger demographics.	Providing internship opportunities and networking for students; using Cardano as a primary example in broader blockchain sessions.	Students and newcomers looking for network building.	Market cooling down; difficulty for new users to absorb complex technical information.
Cosmin	Romania	Prioritize frictionless onboarding and user safety through intuitive product design.	Using plain language, flagging problematic coins, and pushing users toward low-risk activities like staking.	Application users and new crypto investors.	Security fears; risk of scams and problematic coins; user friction in wallet creation.
James	United States	Critical of current value propositions, noting that real-world problem solving isn't attracting users.	Acknowledges that 'Cardano is better than your bank' could be a future hook once UX is ready.	General public and strangers to crypto.	Most people only care about making money; failure of local Catalyst proposals; crypto stigmatization.
Jeremy	Taiwan	Focus on 'main course' benefits like growth momentum and yield rather than technical details.	Masterclass-style presentations for professionals/gov; demonstrating broad global usage via dApps.	Professionals, government entities, and yield-seekers.	People don't want to understand Haskell/Plutus; current exodus of people from the space.
Leo	Taiwan	Pragmatic focus on stable yields and localized education to overcome cultural barriers.	Utilizing Chinese YouTube content and messaging apps; implementing 'chain abstraction' for Web2 users.	20-40 year old young professionals and students.	Lack of localized Chinese information; high Web2 barrier; crypto stigmatization as 'scams'.
Vlad	Romania	Users care about features and benefits (like banking), not the underlying complex technology.	Emphasizing competitive features, fees, transaction speed, and staking yield percentages.	Users in East European side seeking to minimize costs and lend funds.	Lack of trust compared to regulated banks; blockchain seen as 'Wild West'.
Damian	Canada	Education must first address and dismantle the perception that crypto is purely gambling/scams.	Proving technical authenticity and the safety of early investments to students.	University students.	News of rugpulls and meme coins; crypto feels like a gambling site.
Lucas	Portugal	Utility-first philosophy ('Learn, Manage, Build') rejecting typical crypto jargon.	Cross-industry marketing at non-crypto events; using analogies like 'digital terrain' for ADA.	Business owners, small/medium businesses, nomads, and regulators.	Greed/inflation concerns; regulatory compliance gaps.
Eric (BigLazyCat)	Canada	Prioritize essential practical skills like wallet safety and self-custody over governance.	Providing high-quality video content for self-learning; focusing on staking and wallet basics.	Chinese-speaking newcomers and general Cardano community.	Safety of assets; complexity of governance for new users.

Agenda 1: Regional Onboarding Strategies & User Profiles

Neal initiated the first agenda to discuss the target groups and promotion strategies of each region.

- Hong Kong & Singapore (Hinson / TW): The Hong Kong team initially focused on recruiting developers and interns. Recently, they shifted to building public awareness and actively engaging with traditional financial institutions to develop high-frequency trading and DeFi products, attempting to bridge traditional finance capital with Cardano technology. Neal added that for the student demographic, the focus is on providing internship opportunities and networking.
- Romania Vesper (Cosmin): From a product designer's perspective, the primary task is to allow users to "create a wallet quickly and frictionlessly." Once in the App, communication must use plain language and provide a sense of security, such as flagging problematic tokens to protect beginners from scams.
- US & TAIWAN The "Value Proposition" Dilemma (James / Jeremy): James admitted frankly that the general public is no longer interested in "what real-world problems blockchain can solve"; most people only truly care about "whether they can make money." Newman agreed that there is currently an urgent crisis of lacking a value proposition. Former CF member Jeremy emphasized that we must distinguish between the "main course and the side dish" in promotion. The public does not want to understand Plutus or Haskell; we must return to discussing the positive growth momentum of projects and staking yields.

Participants from other regions indicated that the user characteristics discussed above were largely consistent with those observed in their respective regions. Therefore, no further input was provided.

- Portugal & Taiwan Leo & Lucas Comprehensive Written Views and Analysis

During the discussion of regional user goals, Leo & Lucas detailed the user profile and onboarding pain points in both regions through chat and a written report:

- Regional User Profile: The target audience is 20-40-year-old young professionals and students. The primary motivation is staking yields (stable ADA rewards), followed by DeFi and NFT participation, and a long-term research-oriented belief in Cardano's sustainability. Compared to Western users, Taiwanese users are more pragmatic—they prefer low-risk, steady-return opportunities over high-leverage speculation.
- Discovery and Trust Sources: Primarily discovered through YouTube (e.g., Blockchain Daily Derek, Bullish Dumpling), followed by Telegram (DayDayAda), Line OpenChat information stations, and friend recommendations.
- Top 3 Drop-off Points for Beginners:
 - High Web2 User Experience Barrier: The onboarding process is not simple enough. It is recommended to design stronger "chain abstraction" so users can experience Web3 seamlessly.

- Lack of Long-term Organized Activities: Insufficient continuous exposure and community events lead to low visibility for Cardano in Taiwan.
- Crypto Stigmatization: Society has a deep-rooted negative stereotype (scams) regarding cryptocurrency, requiring long-term education.
- Region-Specific Obstacles: Severe lack of in-depth localized Chinese information (information gap), regulatory compliance concerns, fiat on/off-ramp convenience, and mobile-first preference (high usage of mobile wallets).
- Current Onboarding Methods: Relying on Chinese YouTube content + messaging app discussion groups + occasional offline events. The key hook is the first-time staking or participating in local meme project events.

Agenda 2: Workshop Curriculum Planning and Discussion

Neal proposed six main topics for the workshop: Introduction to Blockchain (using Cardano as an example), Staking and Delegation, Governance, Ecosystem dApps, Wallet Operations and Transactions, and Security Precautions (including an on-site ADA airdrop for users to test transfers).

Curriculum Priority and the "Bank" Analogy:

- BigLazyCat (Eric from Canada): Regarding these six topics, an intro is necessary. For the other five, I vote that "staking", "wallet", and "safety & self-custody" should take the first priority. Governance and Apps can come later.
- Newman: I suggest a focus on the common tools of the ecosystem - the wallet and the explorers.

Vlad (Romania Vesper): The public does not need to understand Cardano's complex technology. "It's the same with banks, right? I don't understand how transactions are made with my banking application, but I still use it." Users only really care about: features, fees, transaction speed, and staking yield percentages.

Extended Discussion:

- Newman: Absolutely what Vlad said: "I use banks without fully understanding how it works." But I trust the bank, and I know very well if I do this, then I get that. Why trust the bank? 'cause I got a little bank book as a little kid with Mom and Grandma.
- James Dunseith: So the value prop would be "Cardano is better than your bank". We'll have good UX ready when that's true!.
- Newman: Oh! That's a regional difference... what do banks look like in your country? Did BaBa and MaMa take kids to banks in Taiwan or in Canada?.
- BigLazyCat: In Canada, nope I think.
- Hinson: Asia got quite a lot "investment board game".

Damian (Canadian Student): When students hear about crypto, their first instinct is scams, rug pulls, and meme coins; it feels like a gambling site. Therefore, the primary task during onboarding is to prove the authenticity of the technology and the safety of early investments.

Cosmin: Echoing Damian, he pointed out that workshops should not let beginners trade random tokens right from the start. They should guide them to participate in low-risk activities (like staking), which allows them to interact with the ecosystem in a safer way.

Leo's Supplementary Suggestions on Curriculum Scope:

Leo suggested focusing on the "Minimum Necessary Knowledge": including ADA acquisition and wallet operations, explaining transaction fees in plain language, clarifying staking myths (including introducing local TEN Pools), preventing common scam cases in Taiwan, and strongly recommended adding "chain abstraction" teaching to avoid excessive underlying technical details like the complete Ouroboros mechanism.

Agenda 3: Unique Promotion Strategies and Cross-Industry Collaboration

- Jeremy Firster: This is a great masterclass style presentation for content and building trust with professionals and gov't. I would put more weight behind Ecosystem and dApps to highlight existing projects on Cardano to demonstrate broad usage globally.
- Newman: Learners or onboarding people need to understand their own 'conceptual landscape', preconceptions, needs, goals, expectations. For example, as a learner am I risk averse or... Lucas!!! Lucas has been working on this topic for as long as I've been here. His focus is on the user's need and expected utility.

Lucas (Portugal): Shared a highly unique, non-typical promotion strategy:

- Core Philosophy: "Learn, Manage, Build".
- Rejecting Crypto Jargon: Deliberately avoiding terms like "crypto" or "yield," and only discussing "Web3 utility," such as digital books and digital concert tickets.
- Vivid Analogies: Comparing Bitcoin to digital money and ADA to "digital terrain"; staking is for offsetting inflation. Teaching the use of stablecoins (Djed/USDM) to hedge risks.
- Cross-Industry Marketing: Refusing to use X (Twitter), focusing entirely on Instagram, LinkedIn, and Facebook. They wear Cardano t-shirts to non-crypto events, such as digital nomad conferences, local music festivals, and NFT art summits, successfully reaching out to local Portuguese regulators and lawyers. He also found that "governance" is highly attractive to certain people.

Neal (Host): Praised Lucas's strategy as comprehensive. He noted that different regions rely on different platforms (e.g., YouTube in Taiwan) and proposed including the online resources of content creators in the playbook, such as Eric's (BigLazyCat) channel.

- Leo: (Shared a string of YouTube tutorial playlist links in the chat).
- Newman: Last thing on topics - would love a bit on the explorers - Cexplorer and Cardanoscan.

Agenda 4: User Retention and Next Steps

Neal (Host): Entering the final agenda: after hosting the workshop, how do we ensure users stay in the ecosystem?.

[Leo's Suggestions on Retention and Next Steps:]

Suggested changing the workshop evaluation method to "completing the first staking task at the end" plus a "1-week follow-up confirmation." Subsequently, small amounts of ADA or NFTs could be provided as incentives. He also suggested exploring collaborations with "university clubs" to reduce stigmatization from the root and cultivate the next generation.

Lucas (Portugal): Suggested developing a notification system similar to the Catalyst App, allowing users to subscribe to events or governance pushes they are interested in. At the same time, establishing community "rituals," such as regular online gatherings to celebrate the "end of an Epoch," or participating in Cardano Over Coffee. Cosmin (Romania Vesper): Echoing the push notification suggestion, he stated that the Vesper wallet is implementing a banner system, which will allow ecosystem news and events to be pushed directly to users within the App in the future.

Conclusion and Group Photo

Neal summarized the action plan:

1. Consolidate all feedback collected today (including community channels from various regions) into a comprehensive "Onboarding Playbook" and upload it to GitHub.
2. Host trial workshops to test and optimize the teaching materials. (Leo also indicated in his report his willingness to assist in recruiting and hosting the trial workshop in Taiwan).
3. The final version will be translated into three versions: English, Chinese, and Japanese.